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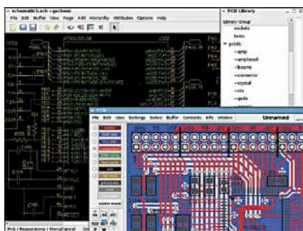


Fig. 3: 'gschem' schematic editor in gEDA project (Source: Wikipedia)

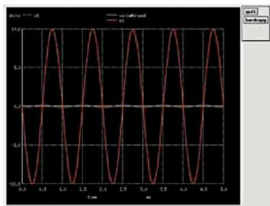


Fig. 4: gEDA simulations



Fig. 5: KiCad tool (Source: Wikipedia)

(BOM) generation, netlist generation, analogue and digital simulation, and printed circuit board (PCB) layout. It runs on Linux platform.

'gschem' schematic editor in gEDA project (Fig. 3) is a powerful tool to register your designs. The symbol libraries are also very rich and people are regularly contributing new libraries. There are some printing issues with 'gschem' schematics though, but

the blogs suggest that these issues will be rectified very soon.

Schematics can be directly imported into another package called 'PCB.' The footprint library of this tool is also large enough and new footprints can be made very quickly. Routing and other features are very easy to learn and use. Netlist, Gerber and BOM can be directly generated for production.

gEDA project also supports design simulations (Fig. 4), which makes it a preferred choice over other design tools.

KiCad. KiCad EDA software suite lets you create professional-grade schematics and printed circuit boards (Fig. 5). Unlike gEDA, it runs on Windows, Linux and Apple OS X.

'Eeschema' schematic editor of KiCad can create very good, professional schematics. Symbol libraries are equally good and new symbols can be created very quickly. The project manager ensures smooth navigation between different packages, which gEDA project lacks.

Schematics can be directly imported to make the PCB. 'Pcbnew' is the package that handles PCB design. The PCB tool of KiCad is very powerful and even a 3D view of the

final PCB is possible. Similar to gEDA Project, production documents can be easily created.

Currently, KiCad does not support design simulations.

Answers compiled by EFY technical editor, Ankit Gupta. Letters and questions for publication may be addressed to Editor, Electronics For You, D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi 110020 (E-mail: editsec@efyindia.com) and should include name and address of the sender